"The world is much too wonderful to be afraid of exploring it."

Love, Camile

Camile's Great Big Wonderful World Adventure

Camile's

Great Big Wonderful World Adventure

The story of one little doll, seven continents, a magical flute, and a suitcase full of memories.



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The story of one little doll, seven continents, a magical flute, and a suitcase full of memories.

1. Virginia
2. New York
3. Peru
4. Paris
5. Marrakech
6. Jaipur
7. Tokyo
8. Sydney
9. Antarctica
10. home!

This book belongs to

_____

My Own Adventure

Draw a place you would love to visit!

My Own Adventure

Draw a place you would
love to visit!

Chapter 1

A Very Small Suitcase and a Very Big World



Camile was not an ordinary doll.

Well, she looked like an ordinary doll. She had bright blue eyes, fluffy blonde hair, and a pink sparkly dress that glittered whenever she danced.

But Camile had a secret.

She was a world traveler.

And not just any world traveler. Camile had climbed mountains, sailed across oceans, tasted foods with names she couldn't pronounce, and once danced for three hours at a wedding where she didn't understand a single word anyone was saying.

She understood the music, though.

Camile always understood the music.

One sunny morning in Virginia, Camile stood beside her little pink suitcase, studying a map of the world.

"Seven continents," she whispered. "Seven enormous, extraordinary continents."

She traced a finger across the map.

North America. South America. Europe. Africa. Asia. Australia. Antarctica.

Then she looked at her suitcase.

It was very small.

Camile's Travel Rules

1. **Travel light.**
2. **Listen carefully.**
3. **Be kind.**
4. **Try the food.**
5. **Learn the words.**
6. **Dance when the music starts.**
7. **Make a new friend.**

Where should Camile go next?
Draw it here!

Say It Like Camile

Peru (Spanish)

Hello
Hola!
(OH-lah)

Thank you
Gracias!
(GRAH-see-ahs)

France (French)

Hello
Bonjour!
(bohn-ZHOOR)

Thank you
Merci!
(mair-SEE)

Morocco (Arabic)

Hello
Marhaba!
(MAR-ha-ba)

Thank you
Shukran!
(SHOOK-ran)

India (Hindi)

Hello
Namaste!
(NUH-muh-stay)

Thank you
Dhanyavaad!
(dun-yuh-VAHD)

Japan (Japanese)

Hello
Konnichiwa!
(kohn-NEE-chee-wah)

Thank you
Arigatō!
(ah-ree-GAH-toh)

Try saying hello to a friend
in a brand new language today!

Inside were four outfits, a toothbrush, a tiny notebook, a pencil, and her most precious possession: a silver flute.

"Perfect!" Camile declared. "Everything I need!"

She did not pack seven pairs of shoes. She did not pack a hair dryer. She certainly did not pack a television.

"Why carry things," she liked to say, "when you can carry memories instead?"

Camile put on her favorite pink sequined dress and turquoise boots.

She kissed her two best friends, Emerson and Norah, goodbye and promised to write from every stop.

"Will you be scared?" Emerson asked.

"Probably sometimes!" Camile said cheerfully.

"Will you get lonely?" Norah asked.

"Maybe a little!"

"Then why are you smiling?"

Camile grinned.

"Because I haven't even left yet, and I've already learned something wonderful."

"What's that?"

"That you can be a little scared and very excited at the same time!"

And with that, she rolled her tiny suitcase down the driveway.

Her great big adventure had begun.

But tonight?

Tonight, Camile dreamed of a great big world.

And all the wonderful friends she hadn't met yet.

The End

At the top, she wrote:

Dear Emerson and Norah,

The world is bigger than we can imagine, filled with more languages than we can count, more songs than we could ever sing, and more delicious meals than we could ever eat.

And every place has something beautiful to teach us.

Travel light. Listen carefully. Be kind. Try the food. Learn the words. Dance when the music starts.

And whenever you can, make a new friend.

The world is much too wonderful to be afraid of exploring it.

Love always,

Camile

She closed her notebook.

Put her flute beside her pillow.

And climbed into bed.

Tomorrow, perhaps, she would start planning her next adventure.

Chapter 2

The City That Never Sleeps

North America



Camile's first airplane landed in New York City.

She pressed her nose against the window as enormous buildings rose toward the clouds.

"Goodness gracious!" she gasped. "It's like somebody planted skyscraper seeds!"

New York was loud.

Taxis honked. Trains rumbled. Street musicians played saxophones, drums, guitars, and instruments Camile had never seen before.

She loved it immediately.

For breakfast, she visited a little bakery where the owner handed her a warm bagel with cream cheese.

"Good morning!" he said.

"Good morning!" Camile answered.

"You visiting?"

"Every continent on Earth!"

The baker blinked.

"That's a pretty big trip for someone so small."

Camile took a tremendous bite of her bagel.

"Good thing I have a tremendous appetite!"

Finally, the music ended.

For a moment, nobody spoke.

Then Norah asked a question.

"Camile, what's the most wonderful place in the whole world?"

Camile thought about it.

She thought about the food.

The music.

The people.

The astonishing things she'd seen.

And finally she answered.

"The most wonderful place in the world?"

She smiled.

"It's wherever you are when you're sharing something wonderful with someone else."

She looked at her two friends.

"And right now, that's here."

Later, when Emerson and Norah were getting ready for bed, Camile opened her notebook one last time.

She turned to a fresh page.

"Marhaba!"

"Namaste!"

"Konnichiwa!"

Then she took out her silver flute.

"Would you like to hear my favorite song from the trip?"

"Which country is it from?" Norah asked.

Camile smiled.

"All of them."

She began to play.

It started softly, like the wind passing over the mountains.

Then it bounced like New York jazz.

Then it danced like a Parisian waltz.

It twisted and twirled with rhythms she'd learned from friends around the world.

Soon Emerson was tapping her feet.

Norah was spinning around the room.

And Camile was dancing too, her blonde hair flying, her pink jacket swishing, and her heart feeling so full it might burst.

That afternoon, she wandered into Central Park and heard the most marvelous sound.

A jazz band was playing beneath the trees.

Camile stopped dancing only long enough to unzip her suitcase and pull out her flute.

"May I join you?"

The trumpet player smiled.

"Can you keep up?"

Camile raised one eyebrow.

"Can you?"

The band laughed.

And then the music began.

The trumpet went BA-BA-BWAAA!

The drums went TSS-BOOM-TSS!

And Camile's little flute went TWEE-TWEE-TWEEE!

Soon everyone was clapping, dancing, and laughing.

That evening, Camile ate dinner at a beautiful restaurant high above the city. Chandeliers sparkled overhead, and a waiter served her a tiny, perfectly arranged plate of pasta.

It was delicious.

But Camile thought the bagel had been just as wonderful.

She opened her notebook.

Dear Emerson and Norah,

New York is HUGE! I played jazz in Central Park and ate breakfast in a bakery and dinner in a restaurant way up in the sky. Both were wonderful!

I learned that the best part of a meal isn't how fancy the restaurant is. It's how happy you feel eating it.

Next stop: South America!

Love, Camile

Camile thought for a moment.

She remembered the lights of New York.

The mountains of Peru.

The sparkling Eiffel Tower.

The lanterns of Morocco.

The dancing in India.

The drums of Japan.

The stars over Australia.

And the brilliant white ice of Antarctica.

Then she looked at Emerson and Norah.

"Absolutely," she said.

"But first, I would like a snack."

Everyone laughed.

That evening, they spread a big blanket across the living room floor.

Camile showed them pictures.

She told stories.

She taught them a few new words.

"Bonjour!"

"Hola!"

At the end of the driveway, Emerson and Norah were waiting.

"CAMILE!"

They ran toward her.

Camile dropped her suitcase and opened her arms.

The three friends hugged and laughed and nearly fell into a flower bed.

"Did you really visit every continent?" Norah asked.

"Every single one!"

"Did you eat strange things?" Emerson asked.

"I ate wonderful things!"

"Did you learn all the languages?"

Camile giggled.

"Not all of them. Not even close! But I learned how to say hello and thank you in quite a few."

"Did you get scared?"

"Sometimes."

"Did you get lonely?"

"Sometimes."

"Would you do it all again?"

Chapter 3

Dancing Above the Clouds

South America



The flight to Peru was long.

Very long.

Camile watched two movies, ate her airplane dinner, took a nap, woke up, read half a book, and looked out the window.

Still flying.

"Excellent!" she whispered. "More time to imagine what's waiting!"

When she landed, she changed into her beautiful blue-and-green dress with its swishy layers and matching bow.

In the city of Cusco, she learned her first Spanish words.

"Hola!" meant hello.

"Gracias!" meant thank you.

And "¡Qué rico!" meant how delicious!

Camile used that last one quite a lot.

At a market, she tried warm corn, fresh bread, and a bowl of delicious potato soup.

"¡Qué rico!" she announced.

The woman serving the soup laughed.

Camile flew north.

Then north again.

Then a little farther north.

She slept on airplanes, read books in airports, and watched clouds drift past her windows.

She didn't mind the long journey.

Long airplane rides had become one of her favorite places to think.

Finally, her plane landed in Virginia.

Camile stepped off wearing her cozy pink jacket and carrying her little suitcase.

It looked exactly the same as when she'd left.

Perhaps a bit more scratched.

Perhaps a little dusty.

But still small.

Inside, Camile had tucked away a few treasured memories: a tiny postcard, a ribbon, some photographs, her notebook, and her silver flute.

She hadn't needed to buy much.

She had brought home something better.

Stories.

Chapter 9

The Best Place in the Whole Wide World



Later, Camile traveled into the mountains, where the ancient stone city of Machu Picchu stood high among the clouds.

She stared in amazement.

"How did people build something so beautiful so long ago?"

Her guide explained that the Inca people had been remarkable builders who understood stone, mountains, and the land around them.

Camile listened carefully.

That night, in a nearby village, musicians played traditional Andean melodies on wooden flutes called quenas.

Camile's eyes widened.

"You play the flute too!"

One musician offered to teach her a melody.

It sounded different from anything she had learned before. The notes floated and curved like birds flying through the mountains.

Camile practiced.

She squeaked.

She tried again.

She squeaked louder.

Everyone laughed kindly, including Camile.

Finally, she found the melody.

The musician smiled.

Together they played beneath the stars while the villagers danced.

Camile's little blue-and-green skirt spun round and round.

Before bed, she wrote another letter.

Dear Emerson and Norah,

Peru is magnificent! I visited mountains so high they touched the clouds, learned to say "¡Qué rico!" when something tastes delicious, and played a beautiful song with Andean musicians.

My flute sounded terrible at first. But I learned that being bad at something new is just the beginning of getting good at it.

Also, potatoes are VERY important here, and I approve completely.

Love, Camile

Dear Emerson and Norah,

I MADE IT TO ANTARCTICA!

There are penguins and mountains made of ice and the most beautiful silence I've ever heard.

I had dinner with scientists from around the world. We shared soup, bread, stories, and music. It was just as wonderful as any fancy restaurant.

There aren't many restaurants in Antarctica, but I think I've learned something important.

A table becomes special because of the people sitting around it.

I've visited all seven continents now. But do you know something funny?

The place I'm most excited to visit next is home.

Love, Camile

A gentle waltz from Paris.

A lively beat inspired by Morocco.

A dancing phrase she remembered from India.

A peaceful musical pause from Japan.

A cheerful tune from Australia.

And then something entirely new.

Something that belonged to this moment.

When she finished, the room was silent.

Then everyone applauded.

Outside, the icy world was still and quiet.

Camile stood by the window, holding her flute.

"Seven continents," she whispered.

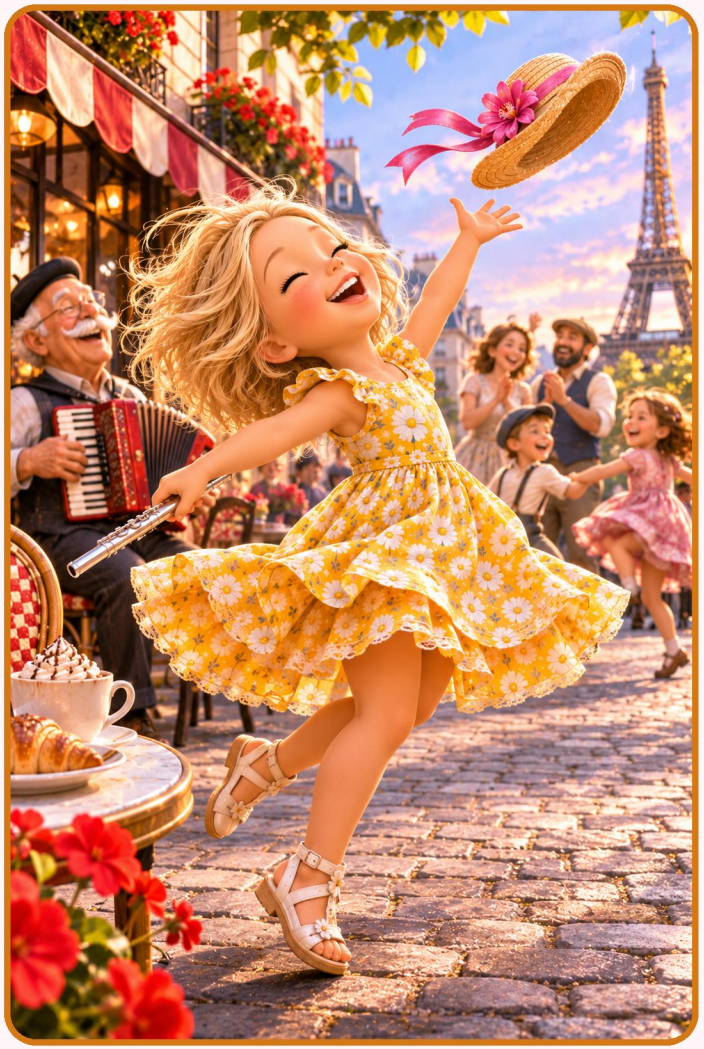
She had done it.

She wrote her longest letter yet.

Chapter 4

The Most Wonderful Croissant in Paris

Europe



Camile arrived in Paris wearing her sunny yellow flowered dress and a straw hat tied with a pink ribbon.

"Bonjour!" she said proudly.

She had practiced the word all the way across the Atlantic Ocean.

"Bonjour!" answered the woman at the bakery.

Camile gazed into the glass display.

Croissants. Éclairs. Macarons. Tarts covered with strawberries.

"Oh dear," Camile whispered. "I may need to move here."

She ordered a croissant and a cup of hot chocolate.

The croissant was warm and buttery and so flaky that crumbs scattered down her dress.

Camile carefully picked up one crumb.

"Too delicious to waste."

She walked along the Seine, admired the bridges, and stared up at the Eiffel Tower.

That evening, the tower began to sparkle.

Camile gasped.

"Konnichiwa!"

Everyone smiled.

That evening, the scientists invited her to share dinner.

It wasn't a grand restaurant.

There were no chandeliers.

No white tablecloths.

No fancy waiters.

Just a warm room, a big pot of hearty soup, fresh bread, and a group of people far from home.

Camile thought it was one of the finest dinners she'd ever eaten.

Afterward, she took out her silver flute.

"Would anyone like a concert?"

A scientist found a guitar.

Another tapped a rhythm on the table.

Soon the entire room was singing and laughing.

Camile played a melody that borrowed little pieces of everything she had learned.

A jazz rhythm from New York.

A mountain melody from Peru.

She put on her warmest clothes, a puffy coat over her pink travel outfit, a scarf, mittens, and enormous snow boots.

She looked down at her feet.

"I appear to be wearing two small boats."

An expedition guide explained that Antarctica had no permanent towns like the other continents.

Instead, scientists and support teams lived at research stations, studying the ice, oceans, weather, and wildlife.

"Then who will I dance with?" Camile asked.

The guide smiled.

"Scientists love dancing too."

At the research station, Camile met people from several different countries.

They spoke different languages.

Some knew English. Some spoke Spanish, French, Mandarin, or other languages.

Camile tried greetings she'd learned along her journey.

"Hola!"

"Bonjour!"

"It looks like a thousand tiny stars decided to visit Paris!"

At dinner, she visited an elegant French restaurant with white tablecloths, little candles, and a waiter who brought courses so beautiful Camile almost felt bad eating them.

Almost.

She tasted delicate vegetables, creamy sauce, and the tiniest chocolate dessert she had ever seen.

"Magnifique!" she declared.

The next morning, she visited a small neighborhood café, where an elderly gentleman was playing an accordion.

Camile sat beside him.

"Would you like some company?"

The gentleman nodded.

She raised her silver flute, and together they played a cheerful waltz.

An elderly woman stood up and began to dance.

Then a couple joined her.

Then two children.

Before long, the entire café was dancing.

Camile twirled so fast her straw hat fell off.

She caught it with one hand and finished the dance with a bow.

"Merci beaucoup!" everyone cheered.

That night, Camile wrote by the light of her hotel window.

Dear Emerson and Norah,

Paris smells like fresh bread and flowers! I learned "bonjour" and "merci," which means thank you. I ate in a fancy restaurant and a little café, and the café turned into a dance party!

I think the Eiffel Tower is beautiful, but do you know what's even more beautiful? Watching strangers become friends when music starts playing.

I miss you both. I hope you're dancing at home!

Love, Camile

Camile had visited six continents.

Now she needed one more.

Antarctica.

She traveled to the southern tip of South America, where she joined a carefully organized expedition sailing toward the icy continent.

The journey across the ocean was rough.

The ship rocked.

The waves splashed.

Camile looked out the window.

"Well," she said, "the ocean certainly knows how to dance!"

At last, enormous white mountains appeared in the distance.

Icebergs floated across the sea like giant frozen castles.

Penguins waddled along the shore.

Seals rested on the ice.

And everything seemed to sparkle.

Camile had never seen anything so beautiful.

Chapter 8

The Coldest Concert in the World

Antarctica



Chapter 5

The Music of Marrakech

Africa



Camile's next flight carried her south across the Mediterranean Sea to Morocco, in Africa.

She arrived in Marrakech, where the buildings glowed pink and orange beneath the afternoon sun.

The markets were full of colors.

Red carpets. Blue pottery. Golden lanterns. Mountains of fragrant spices.

Camile had never smelled so many wonderful things at once.

"Marhaba!" said a shopkeeper.

"Marhaba!" Camile replied.

She learned that it was an Arabic greeting, and that "shukran" meant thank you.

She also heard people speaking Moroccan Arabic and Amazigh languages.

"More languages!" Camile exclaimed. "My notebook is going to be full!"

At lunchtime, she visited a tiny restaurant tucked down a narrow lane.

The cook brought her a steaming tagine filled with vegetables, tender meat, and warm spices.

Camile lifted the lid.

Later, during an open community music activity, she played her flute alongside local musicians.

That evening, she danced joyfully beneath the stars.

The sky looked different here.

She could see constellations she had never seen at home.

"Even the stars have new stories to tell!" she whispered.

Dear Emerson and Norah,

Australia is marvelous! I saw the Sydney Opera House, ate Tim Tams, learned about some of the world's oldest living cultures, and made music beneath a sky full of unfamiliar stars.

I learned that being a good traveler means being a good listener. People have wonderful stories to share when you take the time to hear them.

One continent left!

And it's going to be COLD!

Love, Camile

Camile tried one.

Then another.

Then she politely asked whether it would be possible to have one more.

That evening, she enjoyed a delicious seafood dinner at a restaurant overlooking the harbor.

The lights shimmered on the water, and the Opera House glowed in the distance.

But her favorite part of Australia came the next day.

At a cultural center, Camile attended a performance featuring Aboriginal musicians and storytellers.

She learned that Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples have many distinct cultures, languages, and traditions stretching back thousands of years.

A musician explained how music and storytelling can preserve knowledge about people, places, and history.

Camile listened with enormous interest.

She didn't interrupt.

She didn't assume she already understood.

She asked questions, thanked the performers, and learned the importance of respecting traditions that belong to other communities.

A delicious cloud of steam floated toward her nose.

"Oh! That smells like a hug!"

She ate with fresh bread and finished every bite.

That evening, she visited a beautiful courtyard restaurant surrounded by carved arches, fountains, and hundreds of glowing lanterns.

Musicians were playing drums and stringed instruments.

Camile asked about the rhythm.

One drummer tapped out a pattern.

DUM-da-da-DUM!

Camile tried to copy it with her hands.

DUM-da-DUM-da—

"Oops!"

She tried again.

And again.

Soon she could clap along.

Then she brought out her flute.

The musicians welcomed her into their circle, and together they made a new melody.

It wasn't quite French music.

It wasn't quite Peruvian music.

It was something new.

Something they had created together.

Camile danced beneath the lanterns until her feet were tired and her cheeks hurt from smiling.

Dear Emerson and Norah,

Morocco is full of beautiful colors, delicious smells, and wonderful music! I learned "marhaba" and "shukran," and ate the tastiest tagine.

Tonight, the musicians taught me a rhythm I'd never heard before. I shared a flute melody, and we made something new together.

The world has so many different kinds of music. I want to hear every single one!

Love, Camile

The flight to Australia was Camile's longest yet.

She watched the sunrise from above the clouds.

She watched the sunset.

She slept.

She woke up and ate breakfast.

Then she looked at the airplane map.

"Still over the ocean!" she said happily.

She pulled out her notebook.

"Excellent. I have time to write down everything I want to learn."

In Sydney, she stepped off the airplane and put on her yellow flowered dress again.

"Hello, Australia!"

The Sydney Opera House stood beside the harbor like enormous white sails.

Camile stared at it.

"That building looks like music!"

She spent the afternoon exploring the waterfront, where she met a family who invited her to a picnic.

They shared fresh fruit, sandwiches, and little chocolate-covered biscuits called Tim Tams.

Chapter 6

A Thousand Colors and a Thousand Smiles

Asia



Chapter 7

A Dance Beneath the Southern Stars

Australia



Camile arrived in Jaipur, India, as the sun rose over the city.

She wore her blue-and-green dress again, but added colorful bangles she'd bought at a market.

Everywhere she looked, she saw beautiful patterns.

Painted doors. Bright fabrics. Colorful flowers. Intricate carvings.

A friendly shopkeeper greeted her.

"Namaste!"

"Namaste!" Camile replied.

She learned that many languages were spoken in India, and that Hindi was one of them.

"Dhanyavaad," she practiced. "Thank you!"

At lunchtime, a family invited Camile to share a homemade meal.

There was warm naan bread, fragrant rice, dal, and vegetables cooked with delicious spices.

Camile dipped the naan into the dal.

Her eyes widened.

"Oh, that's wonderful!"

The grandmother smiled.

Before leaving Asia, she sat beside her hotel window and wrote.

Dear Emerson and Norah,

Asia is so enormous that I visited two countries and still barely began exploring it!

In India, I learned a dance that tells a story. In Japan, I learned "konnichiwa," heard incredible drums, and discovered that chopsticks take practice.

I made new friends by trying things I didn't know how to do. I think that's a wonderful way to travel.

Love, Camile

There she changed into her pink travel jacket, starry teal leggings, and comfortable sneakers.

In Tokyo, she learned to bow politely and say "konnichiwa" for hello and "arigatō" for thank you.

She ate noodles at a tiny ramen shop, where she practiced eating with chopsticks.

The first noodle slipped away.

The second noodle slipped away.

The third noodle landed on her sleeve.

Camile laughed.

"Well! I seem to be feeding my jacket!"

But she kept practicing.

Soon she was happily slurping noodles like everyone around her.

Later, she attended a festival and heard the thunderous rhythms of taiko drums.

DON! DON! DOKO-DON!

Camile loved the energy.

She played her flute during a quieter musical gathering and learned to listen for the spaces between the notes, not just the notes themselves.

"Have some more."

Camile happily agreed.

That evening, she attended a celebration with musicians and dancers wearing beautifully colorful clothes.

A musician showed her a tabla, a pair of drums that could make astonishingly complicated rhythms.

Camile listened carefully.

Then she played a melody on her flute.

A girl about Norah's age began teaching her some dance movements.

Camile copied her hands.

Then her feet.

Then everything at once.

She got completely tangled up and nearly fell over.

The little girl giggled.

Camile giggled too.

"Perhaps," Camile said, "we should try that one again."

By the end of the evening, Camile had learned a short dance.

She had also learned that Indian classical and folk dances could tell stories through movements, rhythm, and expression.

"Imagine!" she said. "You can tell a whole story without saying a word!"

A few days later, she traveled on to Japan.

Asia, part two

Next Stop: Japan!

